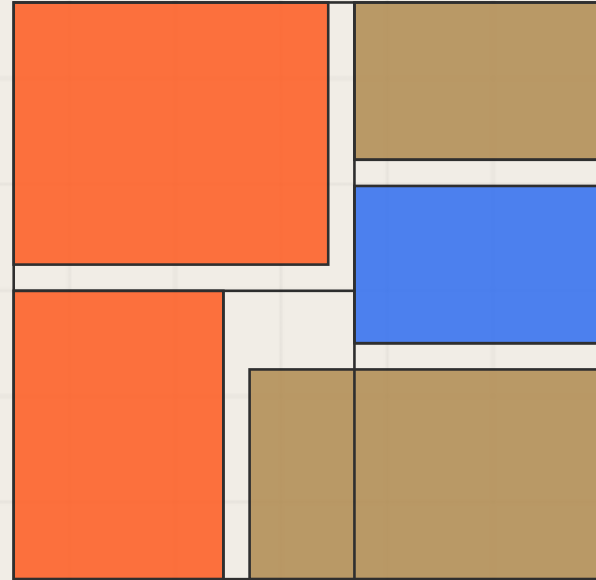


Meanwhile ■



PROJECT HANDBOOK · COMMERCIAL VACANCY MONETIZATION

Half rent. *Full opportunity.*

Meanwhile — the marketplace for the in-between.

PROJECT	DRAWING	SCALE	DRAWN BY
Meanwhile (fmr. SemiRent)	Handbook Rev. 04	₹0 → ₹30k / 1:1	made. by ac

Meanwhile — Project Handbook

Name: “Meanwhile” (formerly the working title “SemiRent”). A complete guide to what this project is, what it does, how every part works, and how it’s built. If you’ve never seen the project before, read this top to bottom and you’ll understand all of it.

Table of contents

1. [What Meanwhile is \(in one minute\)](#)
 2. [The problem it solves](#)
 3. [The core idea — “the third option”](#)
 4. [How it works \(the model\)](#)
 5. [Who it’s for](#)
 6. [The business / revenue model](#)
 7. [A worked example](#)
 8. [The website — section by section](#)
 9. [The interactive demo app](#)
 10. [Design system & art direction](#)
 11. [How it’s built \(technical\)](#)
 12. [Running, building, deploying](#)
 13. [Naming](#)
 14. [What’s built vs. what isn’t](#)
 15. [Credits](#)
-

1. What Meanwhile is (in one minute)

Meanwhile is a marketplace for *temporary commercial occupancy*.

Commercial property — shops, offices, restaurant units — often sits **empty for months** while the owner searches for the perfect long-term tenant. During that time it earns **zero** while still costing money (taxes, upkeep). Meanwhile, thousands of small businesses can’t afford the upfront cost of a premium location.

Meanwhile connects the two. An owner lists a vacant unit at a **reduced, temporary rate**. A growing business moves in for a defined period at a fraction of full rent. When a long-term tenant appears, the temporary occupant gets fair notice — or converts to the full lease.

- The owner **earns income during vacancy** instead of nothing.
- The business **accesses a premium location** it otherwise couldn't.
- Nobody is locked in.

Tagline: **Half Rent. Full Opportunity.** One-line pitch: *Meanwhile helps commercial property owners monetize vacant spaces through temporary discounted occupancy, while enabling startups and small businesses to access premium locations at affordable rates.*

Important: what's built today is a **design showcase + interactive demo** — a beautiful, working front-end with mock data, created by the studio **made. by ac** to demonstrate design capability. It is **not** a live marketplace (no real accounts, payments, or backend). See §14.

2. The problem it solves

For property owners

A vacant commercial space is a standoff nobody wins. While the owner waits for the ideal tenant, the unit creates:

- **Lost rental income** — every empty month is revenue gone forever.
- **Ongoing costs** — maintenance, taxes, security continue regardless.
- **Reduced activity** — a dark unit attracts no interest; an active one does.
- **Deterioration** — unused spaces decay faster.
- **Pressure to drop the rent** — long vacancies force owners to lower their ask.

A vacant property generates **zero return while still accumulating expenses**.

For small businesses

Startups and growing businesses face steep barriers to commercial space:

- **High upfront commitments and large security deposits.**
- **Long-term lease lock-ins** — years of obligation before they're ready.
- **Premium locations priced out of reach.**
- **No way to test demand** before betting the company on a location.

Many never get to test their concept in a high-footfall area purely because of cost.

Both problems are the same gap, seen from two sides. Meanwhile fills it.

3. The core idea — “the third option”

This is the conceptual heart of the product.

Traditional commercial leasing offers only **two** outcomes for any unit:

1. **Occupied** — a full-paying, long-term tenant.
2. **Vacant** — empty, earning nothing.

Meanwhile introduces a **third**:

Temporary Commercial Occupancy (“Semi”)

The space is occupied. Revenue is generated. The owner keeps full flexibility. The business gets affordability. Everyone wins in the in-between.

We call the category this creates “**commercial vacancy monetization.**” It’s not a property portal, not co-working, not a broker — it’s a structured marketplace for the period *between* tenants.

4. How it works (the model)

The property owner

1. Lists a vacant commercial space.
2. Specifies the terms:
 - Monthly (full) rent
 - **Temporary occupancy rent** (the reduced “semi” rate)
 - Notice period
 - Space type, occupancy duration, available facilities
 - Security-deposit requirements
3. The unit becomes visible to **verified** businesses on the platform.

The business occupant

1. Discovers a suitable space (startup, retailer, agency, clinic, café, etc.).
2. Applies instantly.
3. Completes verification (KYC / business screening).
4. Reviews the occupancy conditions.
5. Pays online.
6. Moves in — a premium location at a fraction of the cost.

The transition model (the part that makes it fair)

When the owner finds a long-term tenant, there are two clean outcomes:

- The temporary occupant receives the **agreed notice period** and vacates smoothly, **or**
- If eligible, the occupant **converts into the full-rent tenant** themselves.

Flexibility is written into the contract, not left to chance.

5. Who it's for

Property owners Commercial building owners · retail-shop owners · office owners · real-estate developers · co-working operators · property-management firms.

Businesses Startups · D2C brands · pop-up stores · boutique retailers · agencies · salons · clinics · cafés · creators · freelancers · service providers.

6. The business / revenue model

How Meanwhile (the company) would make money:

STREAM	WHAT IT IS	NOTE
Owner commission	A % of completed transactions	Est. 5–10%
Occupant convenience fee	Small platform fee at booking	Per transaction
Premium listings	Owners pay to promote a listing for visibility	Upsell
Subscription plans	Pro tools for developers / property managers	Recurring
Insurance & protection	Optional damage cover + deposit management	Add-on

7. A worked example

A retail shop's full asking rent is **₹60,000/month**. It's been vacant for three months — earning **₹0**.

The owner lists it on Meanwhile at a temporary rate of **₹30,000/month**. A startup clothing brand moves in.

- **Owner:** now earns ₹30,000/month instead of nothing → **₹90,000 recovered** over three months that would have been zero.
- **Business:** saves ₹30,000/month vs. committing to full rent, in a location it couldn't otherwise afford.

Three months later the startup has grown and **converts to the full lease**. A vacancy problem became a business opportunity.

This exact scenario is the one the website lets you play with interactively (see the **Rent Splitter**, §8).

8. The website — section by section

The marketing site (/) is an immersive, scroll-driven experience. Each section is explained below: **what it is**, **what it shows**, and the **design intent**.

Tip while reviewing: it's desktop-first. Let the **intro curtain** finish on first load, then scroll slowly — much of the storytelling is in the motion.

0. Intro curtain (first load only)

A one-time concrete “curtain” covering the screen. A small floor-plan outline **draws itself**, a room **lights up** (the signal accent), the wordmark settles, and the curtain **lifts** to reveal the hero. Sets the architectural tone in ~2 seconds. Skipped entirely for visitors who prefer reduced motion.

1. Hero — the living floor-plan

What: the opening statement — “*Fill empty spaces. Fuel growing businesses.*” **Shows:** the headline rises line-by-line from behind masks; on the right, an **architectural floor-plan draws its own walls** and its rooms **light up one by one** in the brand colours. **Intent:** the whole concept in one image — empty space being filled with light (occupancy). Drawn, not photographed, because the brand *is* architecture.

2. Live vacancy counter

What: a full-screen dark band with a giant number. **Shows:** an estimate of the **square footage of commercial space sitting vacant in India right now**, which **counts up and never stops ticking** while you watch. **Intent:** make an abstract problem **visceral**. The meter runs whether anyone’s inside or not — “Meanwhile turns the meter the other way.”

3. The problem — facing ledgers

What: the two-sided pain, side by side. **Shows:** two “ledgers” — **For property owners** (avg. 3-month vacancy, the cost list) and **For small businesses** (6-9× rent up front, the barrier list). **Intent:** prove it’s **one gap seen from two sides** — which is exactly what the product bridges.

4. The Third Option — interactive switch ★

What: the core concept, made playable. **Shows:** a three-state toggle — **Vacant / Occupied / Semi**. Flip between them and *everything* updates: the revenue figure, the room visual (windows **light up** as occupancy increases), the headline, and the explanation. “Semi” is the recommended, highlighted state. **Intent:** let the visitor **feel** the third option rather than read about it. This is the centrepiece argument of the page.

5. “Who it’s for” marquee

What: an infinite horizontal ticker. **Shows:** the target customer types (Startups · Pop-up stores · D2C brands · ...) scrolling past, separated by signal diamonds. Pauses on hover. **Intent:** breadth at a glance, and a kinetic palate-cleanser between heavy sections.

6. How it works — horizontal pinned scroll ★

What: the three-move model, told sideways. **Shows:** the section **pins** to the screen and the content **scrolls horizontally** as you scroll down — an intro panel, then **01 List the space** (owner), **02 Apply & move in** (business), **03 Transition** (both), then a result panel: “*A vacancy problem becomes a business opportunity.*” A progress bar tracks the journey. **Intent:** an unexpected, cinematic way to walk through a process most sites present as a boring 3-column row.

7. The Rent Splitter — interactive calculator ★

What: the worked example (§7) as a hands-on tool. **Shows:** a draggable slider sets the **semi rate** as a % of a ₹60,000 full rent. Three live read-outs update instantly: **Owner earns** (vs. ₹0 vacant), **Business saves** (vs. full rent), and **recovered over 3 months**. Both sides **always stay positive** — that's the whole point, made tangible. **Intent:** turn the pitch into proof the visitor generates themselves.

8. Benefits — both sides of the door

What: the payoff, listed cleanly. **Shows:** two editorial columns — **benefits for owners** (revenue during vacancy, visibility, upkeep, verified occupants, flexibility) and **for businesses** (lower entry cost, market validation, reduced risk, growth room, upgrade path). **Intent:** “the rare deal where nobody compromises.”

9. Manifesto — kinetic closer

What: the category claim. **Shows:** a large statement whose words **ignite (brighten) one by one as you scroll** — “*Not a property portal. Not a co-working desk. Not a broker. Meanwhile is an entirely new category — commercial vacancy monetization.*” **Intent:** land the positioning with rhythm and finality.

10. Footer — the blueprint title block ★

What: the most unexpected detail on the page. **Shows:** the footer is drawn as the **spec cartouche from the corner of a real architectural blueprint** — fields for *Project / Drawing / Scale / Status*, plus navigation, company, legal, and the **made. by ac** attribution (“Drawn by”). **Intent:** stay in-world right to the last pixel. The “2% nobody asks for.”

★ = signature / “award-winning” moments — the sections built to be memorable.

9. The interactive demo app

Beyond the marketing page, there are **three designed, working product screens** using mock data (no real backend). They show what the actual platform would feel like.

`/browse` — the index of spaces

- A **filterable grid** of vacant commercial units (filter by type: Retail, Office, F&B, Pop-up, Services; sort by lowest semi rate, biggest saving, or longest vacant).
- Every card shows a **uniquely generated floor-plan thumbnail** (drawn from the listing's ID — no two alike, and zero photo assets needed), the address, size, the **semi rate vs. full rent**, the **discount %**, and **how long it's been vacant** (a live pulsing badge).

`/space/:id` — a listing detail

- A large **drawn plan view** plus a mini gallery of additional drawn views.

- A **specification sheet** (type, floor, area, footfall, notice period, days vacant).
- A **facilities list**.
- A sticky **pricing card**: the temporary rate, the saving vs. full rent, and a line-item breakdown (semi rent, deposit, notice, platform fee).
- An **“Apply to occupy”** button that shows a mock confirmation, plus a **“message the owner”** action and a verified-owner badge.

/dashboard — the owner’s view

- Top stats: **revenue recovered during vacancy**, active occupancies, open inquiries, average fill time.
- A **revenue chart** that tells the story visually: empty months at ₹0 → orange **semi-occupancy** months earning income → a gold month where the tenant **converted to a full lease**.
- A live **inquiries** feed (new / verified / reviewing).
- A **listings table** with per-space status (Occupied / Vacant / Converting).

The mock listings live in `src/data/listings.js` (six spaces across real Indian commercial districts, with ₹ figures and a small currency-formatting helper).

10. Design system & art direction

The concept: *Architectural / Negative Space*

The brief was an **award-winning, unique** site with sections nobody expects for a real-estate product. The chosen direction leans **into the subject itself — empty space**. The result reads like a gallery / blueprint, not a property listings site.

Palette

ROLE	COLOUR	USE
Paper / concrete	warm off-white	primary light surface
Ink	near-black	dark “acts”, text on paper
Signal orange #ff5a1f	the one accent	the action / “lights on in a dark building”
Brass #b08a4f	secondary	provenance / “premium location” warmth
Blueprint blue #2f6df0	structural	technical / plan accents

The signal colour is used sparingly — it represents **occupancy**: a dark (vacant) space coming alive. One accent for the action, never scattered.

Type

- **Fraunces** — editorial display serif (headlines, the wordmark; italic for emphasis words).
- **Hanken Grotesk** — body & UI.
- **Space Mono** — labels, numbers, metadata (the “spec sheet” voice).

Motion (slow, soft, intentional — never bouncy)

- **Smooth scroll** (Lenis) drives the whole page.
- **Scroll reveals** — content rises and fades in as it enters view.
- **Kinetic headlines** — lines rise from behind masks.
- A **custom cursor** — a precise dot with a lagging ring that **morphs into a labelled disc** over interactive elements (desktop only).
- **Magnetic buttons** lean toward the cursor.
- A thin **scroll-progress bar** (signal → brass) at the very top.
- The **nav flips** light-over-dark automatically as it crosses dark sections.
- **Everything honours** `prefers-reduced-motion` — every animation no-ops for visitors who ask for less motion (a hard studio rule).

Recurring visual motifs

The **blueprint grid**, **drawn floor-plans**, **dimension ticks**, and **mono spec-labels** appear throughout so the world feels consistent end to end.

This is built on the **made. by ac** design system (the studio’s house style), adapted with Meanwhile’s own concrete-and-signal palette.

11. How it’s built (technical)

Stack

- **React 18 + Vite 5** (fast dev server + build)
- **Tailwind CSS v4** (via `@tailwindcss/vite` ; design tokens defined in CSS)
- **GSAP 3 + ScrollTrigger** — timeline & scroll-driven animation (the hero plan draw, the horizontal pinned section, the manifesto word-ignite)
- **Lenis** — smooth scrolling, synced to GSAP
- **React Router 6** — the four routes

File structure

```
meanwhile/
├─ index.html          # fonts, meta, the favicon (a lit-room SVG)
├─ src/
│  ├─ main.jsx         # React entry
│  ├─ App.jsx          # router + global layout (cursor, nav, footer, smooth scroll)
│  ├─ styles/index.css  # design tokens + base styles + utility classes
│  ├─ lib/
│  │  ├─ useLenis.js    # smooth scroll + GSAP sync
│  │  ├─ useReveal.js   # IntersectionObserver scroll-reveals
│  │  └─ useMagnetic.js # magnetic-cursor effect
│  ├─ components/
│  │  ├─ Cursor.jsx     # the custom cursor
│  │  ├─ ScrollProgress.jsx
│  │  ├─ Intro.jsx      # the intro curtain
│  │  ├─ Nav.jsx        # header + light/dark flip
│  │  ├─ Footer.jsx     # the blueprint title-block
│  │  ├─ Wordmark.jsx   # the logo
│  │  └─ SpaceThumb.jsx # generates a floor-plan from a listing id
│  ├─ sections/         # the homepage sections (Hero, VacancyCounter,
│                        # Problem, ThirdOption, Marquee, HowItWorks,
│                        # RentSplitter, Benefits, Manifesto)
│  ├─ pages/            # Home, Browse, Listing, Dashboard
│  └─ data/listings.js  # mock spaces + helpers
```

A few notable implementation details

- **Floor-plans are code, not images.** `SpaceThumb` hashes the listing ID into a deterministic little plan, so every space has its own drawing and the site ships with **no photo assets**.
- **The wall-draw animation** uses SVG stroke dash-offset (free) rather than the paid GSAP DrawSVG plugin.
- **The horizontal “How it works”** pins the section and translates a wide track by the scroll distance — a classic GSAP ScrollTrigger pattern.
- **Accessibility:** reduced-motion is detected once and disables Lenis, the cursor, the intro, and all reveals.

12. Running, building, deploying

```
cd ~/meanwhile
npm install      # one-time
npm run dev      # local dev → http://localhost:5173
npm run build    # production build → dist/
npm run preview  # preview the production build locally
```

- **Status today:** runs locally; **not deployed**, no git remote yet.
- **To go live:** it's a static front-end, so any static host works (the studio's usual path would be a `*.made-by-ac.com` subdomain — which needs a DNS record).

13. Naming

The project is named **"Meanwhile."** It started under the working title *"SemiRent"* (semi = half/partial rent), which was descriptive but generic.

Why "Meanwhile": *"meanwhile use"* is the real property-industry term for exactly this idea — putting vacant space to temporary use *meanwhile* a permanent tenant is found. It's premium, ownable, and quietly clever, and it folds the concept straight into the brand: the **third occupancy state is literally called "Meanwhile"** (see the Third Option switch, §8.4) — a space isn't Vacant or Occupied, it's *Meanwhile*.

The wordmark sets **"Mean"** in Fraunces italic and **"while"** upright, closed with the signal-orange square (the lit pixel of an occupied space).

Everything is now "Meanwhile" end to end — the product, wordmark, titles, copy, package name, local folder (`~/meanwhile`) and the Git repo (`asrithcheepurupalli/meanwhile`).

14. What's built vs. what isn't

Built (this is a design showcase + interactive demo):

- The full marketing experience and all signature animated sections.
- Three designed product screens (Browse, Listing, Dashboard) with mock data.
- The complete design system and motion layer.

Not built (it's a concept, not a live product):

- No real accounts, authentication, or KYC.
- No backend, database, or real listings.
- No payments, contracts, or messaging.
- Form actions (apply, message) are mock confirmations only.

A production build would add the marketplace MVP described in §4 and §6.

15. Credits

A **made. by ac** build — design & development studio. Created as a portfolio demonstration of what the studio can do for a product. → made-by-ac.com